

Paddle District — Modes Guide

This is the **Modes** version of Paddle District. It runs the same open-play session manager (players, courts, scoring, leaderboard, live view), but when you create a session you pick a **Format** and a **Matchmaking** style. This guide explains how each one works, in both **Singles** and **Doubles**.

The short version: Format decides team size (1 or 2 per side). Matchmaking decides how the app chooses who plays next. Both are locked in when you create the session.

Choosing your mode

On the **Dashboard**, the New Session card has two dropdowns:

NEW SESSION

Session name (e.g. Friday Open Play)

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FORMAT

Doubles (2v2) 

MATCHMAKING

By wait time 

 **Start New Session**

New Session: Format and Matchmaking pickers

- **Format** — **Doubles (2v2)** or **Singles (1v1)**.
- **Matchmaking** — **By wait time**, **Balanced**, **Random**, **Manual**, or **Ladder**.

You set these once at creation; they stay fixed for the whole session. The current mode is shown as a badge on the Courts tab.

Format: Doubles vs Singles

DOUBLES (2v2)

Court 1

00:31 Rd 2 X

T1 Eve ⇌ Jude ⇌

VS

T2 Jan ⇌ Daccic ⇌

SCORE

0

0

Submit Score

SINGLES (1v1)

Court 1

01:05 Rd 1 X

T1 Eve ⇌

VS

T2 Jan ⇌

SCORE

0

0

Submit Score

A doubles court (two names per team) and a singles court (one per team)

- **Doubles (2v2):** two players per team — each team's row shows two names. A match needs

4 waiting players.

- **Singles (1v1):** one player per team — each row shows one name. A match needs 2

waiting players.

Either way, each team has its own **score box** on the right; enter both and tap **Submit Score**. Scoring, swaps, and the leaderboard behave identically in both formats.

Matchmaking styles

How the app picks who plays next. "Longest-waiting" means whoever has sat out the most since they last played.

By wait time (*default — fairest rotation*)

- **Doubles:** the **4** longest-waiting players, paired into two teams at random.
- **Singles:** the **2** longest-waiting players face off.

Everyone gets near-equal playing time. Best for casual open play.

Balanced (by ranking)

Tries to make **even teams** using each player's record (wins minus losses).

- **Doubles:** takes the 4 longest-waiting, then splits them so the **strongest + weakest** play together against the **middle two** — keeping games close.
- **Singles:** there are no teams to balance, so it works just like **By wait time** (the 2 longest-waiting play). Balanced really only changes things in Doubles.

Random

- **Doubles:** 4 **random** waiting players, randomly paired.
- **Singles:** 2 **random** waiting players.

Good for mixing partners and opponents / social nights.

Manual (pick each match)

You build every match by hand — no auto-queue.

- When a court is open it shows ⚡ **Pick Match**. Tap it, then tap players to fill

Team A first, then **Team B** (1 each for Singles, 2 each for Doubles), and **Start**.

- Works the same in both formats; it just asks for 2 or 4 players.

Ladder — King of the Court

A competitive rotation where **partners stay together** the whole session.

Round 3

Reset

Advance Round →

Court 1

#1 • Top ✓ reported

A

Eve & Jude 🏆

SCORE

11

VS

B

Jan & Daccic

SCORE

7

Update Result

Court 2

#2 • Bottom

A

Ana & Beth

SCORE

0

VS

B

Cy & Dan

SCORE

0

Save Result

BENCH (rotates in at the bottom court)

No teams waiting — everyone's on a court.

Ladder mode: ranked courts with A/B teams, scores, and a bench

- Every court plays each round. **Winners move up** a court, **losers move down**. The **bottom** court's loser rotates to the **bench**, and the front of the bench rotates in.
- **Doubles:** fixed teams of 2. **Singles:** 1-v-1 King of the Court.
- Start it from the Courts tab (**Start Ladder**). Enter each court's result — Ladder needs a **winner**, so no ties — then tap **Advance Round** to move everyone up/down.
- Courts are ranked (#1 Top ... #N Bottom); the bench shows who's waiting to rotate in.

Everything else works the same

Scoring, the **Leaderboard** (tap ⓘ **How it's scored** to see how Wins, Points, and Score Diff are calculated), **Match History**, and the public **live View + QR** all behave exactly like the main Paddle District system: score each match and the standings update live; share the View link or QR so spectators can follow along on their phones.

Screenshots are illustrative renders of the current UI. Your own players, courts, and colors will appear in the live app.